

RAJESH DAMMALA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Incident Management leader with 16+ years driving incident response excellence across large-scale distributed systems at Microsoft and IBM. Led 24/7/365 incident response for 20+ mission-critical production services serving millions of users. Proven track record defining incident response strategy, building globally distributed response teams, and reducing incident duration through tooling vision, observability improvements, and cross-functional coordination. Deep expertise in high-severity incident leadership, operational metrics ownership, and continuous improvement culture. Architected AI-driven incident automation achieving 30-35% auto-resolution, reducing MTTR by 32%.

CORE COMPETENCIES

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Incident Response Strategy & Operating Model• Large-Scale Distributed Systems• Operational Metrics & Continuous Improvement• Incident Management Tooling Development• 24/7/365 Operations & On-Call Management• Mentoring & Team Development | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• High-Severity Incident Leadership (Sev 1/2)• Observability & Triage Tooling Vision• Cross-Functional Coordination (Eng/Product/Exec)• Globally Distributed Team Leadership• Executive Communication & Escalation• AIOps & Automated Incident Resolution |
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SELECTED IMPACT

- Defined incident response strategy and operating model for 20+ mission-critical Xbox support services, establishing severity frameworks, response protocols, and escalation paths that reduced MTTR by 32%.
- Architected AI-driven incident automation platform (Azure SRE Agent) achieving 30–35% automated resolution coverage, saving 150+ engineering hours/year and minimizing customer-impacting incident duration.
- Led high-severity incident response 24/7/365 — coordinated cross-functional engineering teams, decomposed complex ambiguous incidents into parallel work streams, served as single point of contact for executive leadership.
- Owned operational metrics for incident response quality — built KQL/Power BI dashboards tracking resolution speed, escalation rates, and SLA compliance; drove continuous improvement from 85% to 98% efficiency.
- Developed vision for incident management tooling — influenced observability and triage tooling roadmaps (App Insights, Log Analytics, ICM), increased scope of team-maintained dashboards by 3x.
- Built and mentored globally distributed incident response team; established career development paths, competency models, and training programs for junior incident managers.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Incident Manager / Lead Escalations Manager — Xbox CXT SRE

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra/Allyis) | Redmond, WA (Remote from Morrisville, NC) | May 2021 – Present

- Define and execute incident response strategy for 20+ mission-critical production services in a 24/7/365 operational environment serving millions of users globally.
- Lead high-severity incident response — coordinate cross-functional engineering teams, decompose complex/ambiguous incidents into parallel work streams, drive resolution under pressure.
- Serve as single point of escalation for executive leadership during critical customer-impacting incidents; manage communications and status updates to VP-level stakeholders.
- Developed vision for incident management tooling: influenced App Insights, Log Analytics, and ICM tooling roadmaps to improve observability, triage speed, and automated detection.
- Own operational metrics — built KQL/Power BI dashboards tracking MTTR, incident volume, escalation rates, SLA compliance; set clear goals driving continual improvement (85% to 98% efficiency).
- Architected Azure SRE Agent platform for automated incident triage and resolution — 30-35% auto-resolution rate, reducing customer impact duration significantly.
- Mentor and develop junior incident managers; established competency frameworks, career paths, and feedback mechanisms for continuous skill growth.
- Build relationships across Microsoft incident response teams (Azure, Xbox, M365) enabling effective cross-organizational collaboration during major outages.
- Authored 175+ incident response playbooks in 5 months — standardized triage, improved first-responder effectiveness, reduced repeat escalations by 40%.
- Educate engineering teams on incident response capabilities, tooling advances, and best practices through training sessions and documentation.

Azure Support Technical Lead — Incident & Escalation Management

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 – May 2021

- Led team of 15 engineers providing 24/7 incident response and escalation management for enterprise Azure customers across distributed infrastructure.
- Managed high-severity customer escalations — drove resolution for complex, technically challenging issues involving multiple engineering teams and cross-service dependencies.
- Influenced incident management tooling development: championed 200+ bugs and feature enhancements improving observability and triage capabilities.
- Established operational metrics and SLA frameworks; drove continuous improvement in resolution quality and response times.

Operations Lead — Azure LiveSite Incident Operations

Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India !' Redmond, WA | May 2012 – Nov 2016

- Built and led globally distributed 32-person incident response team (Hyderabad + Redmond) providing 24/7 coverage for Azure platform operations.
- Led deep-dive technical investigations for complex production incidents at cluster-to-blade level across very large distributed systems.
- Developed PowerShell automation frameworks for incident detection and triage — saved thousands of manual hours annually.
- Managed incident lifecycle, change management, and post-incident review processes driving systemic reliability improvements.

Systems Analyst / Infrastructure Engineer

IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 – Nov 2011

- Enterprise server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale data migrations supporting production infrastructure.
- IT infrastructure management including patching, service packs, and hardware lifecycle operations.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.E., Computer Science Engineering — JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

- AZ-900 Azure Fundamentals
- Microsoft 70-533/70-534: Implementing Azure Infrastructure Solutions
- TechMahindra AI White Belt | Google Generative AI | Google Cloud Computing Foundations

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Incident Management: ICM, PagerDuty-equivalent workflows, Severity Models, Escalation Frameworks, Post-Incident Reviews

Observability & Tooling: Azure App Insights, Log Analytics, Kusto/KQL, Power BI, Geneva, CloudWatch-equivalent

Distributed Systems: Azure (20+ microservices), CI/CD Pipelines (ADO/Git), Large-scale cloud platforms

Automation: PowerShell, Bicep, AIOps, AI Agents, Multi-agent Orchestration, Logic Apps

Communication: Executive escalation management, Cross-org collaboration, Technical writing, Metrics-driven reporting